its strength and the damage it would cause. Imran Khan, the chief of Pakistan Tehreek-e-Insaf (PTI), stated that 30,000–40,000 insurgents could not fight and win against half a million men in the Pakistan Army. He conveniently missed all other aspects stated above. It is a relevant lesson to be learnt from contemporary history that protracted over indulgence of the soviet forces in Afghanistan became its bleeding wound and a catalyst of the disintegration of the superpower, the Soviet Union in 1990 (Hussain, 2013).

Situation (see the three main circles in Figure 9.1)

i. Insurgency, backed by Al Qaeda, erupted in FATA area.
ii. Same elements and their affiliates started carrying out terrorist activities in urban centres of Pakistan.
iii. Religious extremism and intolerance seeped into the society after the Soviet–Afghan War and increased after the second Afghan war.

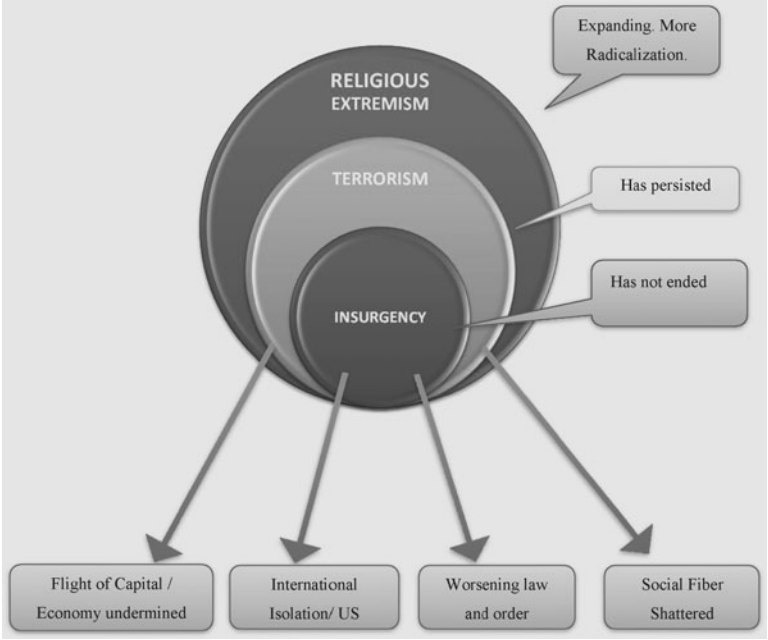


Figure 9.1 Situation, progression and impact.